KAAVYA LAKSHMI

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Interdisciplinary researcher with a background in Cognitive Sciences, Learning Sciences and Psychology, with interests at the intersection of human cognition, emotion, and emerging AI technologies. Experience includes work on emotion and visuospatial working memory, mixed-method research on emotion recognition, and cross-national comparative research on technology access. Interested in studying how people perceive, trust, relate to, and make decisions with increasingly human-like AI systems.

EDUCATION

MSc Cognitive Sciences, Learning and Technology, CGPA: 9.34/10.00 *2024–2026*
Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amrita School of Social and Behavioral Sciences, India
Specialization: Neurophysiology Tools and Learning Technologies
Relevant coursework: Research Methodology; Philosophy of Mind; Virtual Reality, Augmented Reality and Haptics for Learning; Deep Learning; Machine Learning; Computational Neuroscience; Organizational Behaviour

BA (Hons) Psychology, CGPA: 9.65/10.00 (7.72/8.00) *2021–2024*
OP Jindal Global University, Jindal School of Psychology & Counselling, India
Relevant coursework: Research Methodology; Honors Thesis; Cognitive Psychology

CBSE Class XII, Score: 92% *2021*
Deens Academy, Bangalore, India
Psychology, Design, Political Sciences, Economics

CBSE Class X, Score: 89% *2019*
Deens Academy, Bangalore, India

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

University Silver Medal, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham *2026*
Awarded for outstanding academic and research accomplishments in the 2026 graduating class

Batch Silver Medal, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham *2026*
Awarded for second rank in the MSc Cognitive Sciences, Learning, and Technology program

Dean's List, OP Jindal Global University *2024*
Recognized for exemplary academic performance (8.0/8.0 GPA) in the sixth semester of the BA (Hons.) Psychology program

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Teachers' Classification of Students' Emotions *Aug 2025–Present*

- Primary Investigator: Dr. Matthijs Fakkel (Gaurang), Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham
- Mixed-method research analyzing teachers' recognition of students' epistemic emotions.
- Examining whether labels in AI training video datasets adequately captures complex affective states
- Conference paper in preparation: Teachers Rate Classroom Emotions Differently for Girls than for Boys.
- Worked on research design, ethics submission, data collection, qualitative data analysis, and writing

Global Gender Differences in Access to Technology Support *Dec 2025–Apr 2026*

- Contributed to a study examining gender differences in access to technology support across 29 countries.
- Worked on the manuscript development and revisions
- ***Publication:*** Fakkel, M., Lakshmi, K., Sharma, S., Bell, T., Alkoyak, M., & Ustenko, V. (2026). Global gender differences in access to technology support. Proceedings of the 9th International Conference on Gender Research, 21-29. doi:10.34190/icgr.9.1.4681

The Impact of Emotion on Visuospatial Working Memory, *Undergraduate Honors Thesis* ***Aug 2023–May 2024***

- Supervisor: Dr. Divya Bhatia, OP Jindal Global University
- Designed and executed a controlled cognitive experiment evaluating emotional stimuli's impact on visuospatial working memory
- Implemented a DMDX based change-detection task and analyzed behavioral data to examine memory performance and cognitive load
- Worked on research design, ethics submission, data collection, quantitative data analysis, writing and presentation

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

- **EmoPaw, *Deep Learning Group Project (2025):*** Developed a dog emotion prediction model using Python, CNNs, and MobileNet. Link
- **CandidAI, *Group Project (2025):*** Applied BERT-based models to detect hate and racial bias in AI prompts. Link
- **Computational Neuroscience, *Group Project (2025)***: Modelled single-neuron dynamics of cerebellar Purkinje cells and Deep Cerebellar Nucleus neurons using the Adaptive Exponential Integrate-and-Fire framework
- **GenAI × Gender Technology Hackathon, *Team VirtuProtect (2024)*:** Applied social science perspectives to the development of a generative AI model for detecting child grooming in online conversations. Link
- **Human-Robot Interaction *(2025)*:** Engaged in user centered design research related to Human-Robot Interaction.
- **VR and Haptic technologies *(2026)***: Conducted cognitive walkthroughs to evaluate VR and haptic technologies.
- **Web Development *(2024-2026):*** Designed and developed a personal portfolio website using HTML and prompt engineering, and a Cognitive Labyrinth project website using Google Sites. Link

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Omnex Centre for Immersive & E-Learning Excellence (CIEX), Intern ***Apr–Jun 2026***

- Designed immersive learning experiences for employees
- Developed storyboards, courses and assessments using *Articulate Storyline 360*

Ammachilabs, Ministry of Education: Virtual Skill Labs Project, Intern ***Oct–Nov 2024***

- Contributed to a Virtual Skill Labs module, *Sensor-Operated Faucet Systems*, published on DIKSHA platform.
- Designed learning content, storyboards and action maps using learning theories to support simulations

St. John's Research Institute, Bangalore, Research Intern ***Jun–Jul 2023***

- Reviewed ongoing research on alcohol reduction and intimate partner violence (IPV)
- Observed nurse training for an RCT intervention and research procedures related to study implementation.
- Observed psychiatric case history taking at St. John's Medical Hospital

Snehadhara Foundation, Bangalore, Intern ***Dec 2022–Jan 2023***

- Facilitated and co-facilitated multi-arts skill building sessions for children with special needs
- Documented sessions and adapted engagement approaches based on observed responses

ActionAid, Bangalore, Intern ***Jun 2022***

- Evaluated the digital accessibility and user experience of state government websites for accessing lake Water quality data
- Contributed to a report prepared for the Central Pollution Control Board, India

PROGRAMMES

United Nations Winter Immersion Programme, *UN Institute for Training and Research, Geneva* ***Jan 2024***

Engaged in workshops on negotiations, SDG policy, and multilateral decision-making; gained exposure to global institutions (WMO, ILO, WTO, WIPO, UNHCR) and international policy processes

ACADEMIC PROJECTS & CONFERENCE WORK

International Conference on Immersive Technologies and Social Work ***Mar 2026***

- Led the Marketing sub-committee under the Media, Marketing and Sponsorship Committee.
- Managed conference communications, sponsor documentation and session reporting.

Intervention in Government and Private Schools, Bangarapet ***Jul 2025***

- Designed and facilitated Mathematics and Drone learning sessions for students across government and private schools as part of the MSc program.
- Evaluated students' experience of a gamified learning app, assessing usability and learner engagement.

Cognitive Labyrinth Exhibition: International Conference of Gender and Technology ***Jan 2025***

- Developed the exhibition website using Google Sites and led a stall examining gender biases in disaster management and gender based online facilitated crimes. Link

TECHNICAL & RESEARCH SKILLS

- **Programming & AI:** Python; Machine Learning; Deep Learning; CNNs; MobileNet; BERT; Prompt Engineering; SQL; NEURON simulation software
- **Research Methods:** Experimental Research; Cognitive Experiments; Mixed-Methods Research; Questionnaires; Interviews; Behavioral Data Analysis; Qualitative Analysis; Quantitative Analysis
- **Research Tools:** DMDX; SPSS; Jamovi; Zotero; LitMap
- **Human-AI / HCI:** Human-AI Interaction; Human-Robot Interaction; User-Centered Design; Cognitive Walkthroughs; Virtual Reality; Augmented Reality; Haptics
- **Learning Technologies:** Articulate Storyline 360; Google Sites; HTML; Learning Design

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Behavioral Sciences:** Augmenta Health: Public Mental Health, Digital Mental Health and Helpie Suicide Gatekeeper Training (2022); HarvardX: Humanitarian Response (2021); Fortis Healthcare: Prosocial Peer Moderator Program on Risk Behavior Management, Media Literacy & Gender Sensitivity (2020)
- **Technology:** Microsoft: SQL Foundations (2026); ACM: AI & ML Workshop (2025); DeepLearning.AI: Generative AI for Everyone (2024)
- **Professional Development:** McKinsey: Forward Program (2026)

SOCIETIES

CogSci Club, ***Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeethan*** (2024-2026)***:*** Founding Member; Co-presented an interactive session on emotions and emotion regulation during Mental Health Awareness Week
Aperture Society, ***OP Jindal Global University*** (2022-2024)***:*** Member; Participated in exhibitions and photo walks

SOCIAL SERVICE

Clean Up Drive, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Amritapuri (2025): Assisted in waste segregation
FuelADream Campaign, Bangalore Indiranagar Rotary Trust (2020*):* COVID-19 Relief: Raised contributions to provide 21-day food packs to daily wage workers in Bangalore affected by the pandemic. Link
Kerala Flood Relief (2018**):** Fundraising efforts for communities affected by the Kerala floods

LANGUAGES

English: Proficient | Malayalam: Native | Hindi: Limited Proficiency | German: Elementary Proficiency